

CSS Cheat Sheet

The properties that turn plain HTML into a designed page — selectors, colours, the box model, text and layout at a glance.

SECTIONS

[Selectors](#)[Colours](#)[Box model](#)[Flexbox](#)[Grid](#)

CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) controls *how* a page looks. A rule picks elements with a **selector**, then sets one or more **property: value** pairs. This sheet is your at-a-glance reference for the properties you'll use every single day.

CSS Cheat Sheet

Every CSS rule follows the same shape: a **selector** chooses what to style, and a **declaration block** in `{ }` lists the changes as `property: value;` pairs.

```
selector {
  property: value; /* one declaration */
  color: navy;
}
```

CSS

Three ways to add CSS

```
<!-- 1. Inline: on one element (avoid for real work) -->
<p style="color: red;">Hi</p>

<!-- 2. Internal: in the <head> -->
<style>
  p { color: red; }
</style>

<!-- 3. External: a .css file (best) -->
<link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
```

HTML

TIP

Prefer an **external stylesheet**. It keeps structure (HTML) and style (CSS) separate, and one file can style your whole site. Day 3 covers this in depth.

Selectors

Selector	Targets
<code>*</code>	Every element.
<code>p</code>	Every <code><p></code> (by tag name).
<code>.btn</code>	Every element with <code>class="btn"</code> .
<code>#main</code>	The one element with <code>id="main"</code> .
<code>nav a</code>	Any <code><a></code> inside a <code><nav></code> (descendant).
<code>h1, h2</code>	Both <code>h1</code> and <code>h2</code> (group).
<code>a:hover</code>	A link while the mouse is over it (state).
<code>li::before</code>	Generated content before each <code>li</code> .

Selector	Targets
<code>input[type="text"]</code>	Elements with a matching attribute.

NOTE

Specificity: when rules clash, an `#id` beats a `.class`, which beats a plain `tag`. A later rule beats an earlier one of equal weight.

Colours & backgrounds

```
color: crimson;           /* 140+ named colours */
color: #4f46e5;          /* hex (red green blue) */
color: rgb(79, 70, 229);  /* 0-255 each */
color: rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.5); /* + alpha = see-through */
color: hsl(245, 79%, 59%); /* hue, saturation, light*/

background-color: #f8fafc;
background-image: url("bg.png");
```

CSS

     A colour has three common notations — name, hex, and rgb/hsl — all describing the same thing.

Text & fonts

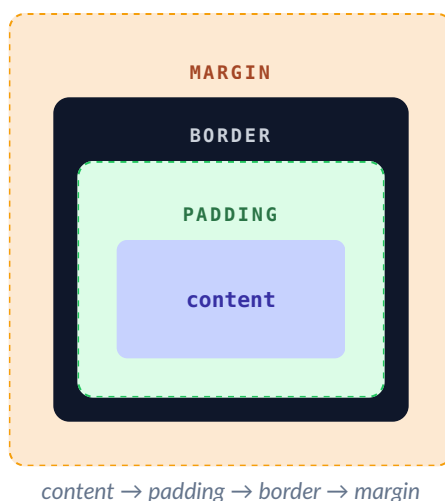
Property	Does
<code>font-family</code>	Which typeface (list fallbacks): <code>Arial</code> , <code>sans-serif</code> .
<code>font-size</code>	Text size: <code>16px</code> , <code>1.2rem</code> .
<code>font-weight</code>	Thickness: <code>normal</code> , <code>bold</code> , <code>100–900</code> .
<code>font-style</code>	<code>normal</code> or <code>italic</code> .
<code>line-height</code>	Space between lines: <code>1.5</code> .
<code>text-align</code>	<code>left</code> , <code>center</code> , <code>right</code> , <code>justify</code> .
<code>text-decoration</code>	<code>underline</code> , <code>none</code> (removes link lines).
<code>text-transform</code>	<code>uppercase</code> , <code>capitalize</code> .
<code>letter-spacing</code>	Space between letters.

Units

Unit	Meaning
<code>px</code>	Pixels — a fixed, absolute size.
<code>%</code>	Relative to the parent element.
<code>em</code>	Relative to the element's own font size.
<code>rem</code>	Relative to the root font size — great for consistency.
<code>vw</code> / <code>vh</code>	1% of the viewport's width / height.

The box model

Every element is a box built from four layers, inside → out:



Property	Controls
<code>width</code> / <code>height</code>	Size of the content area.
<code>padding</code>	Space <i>inside</i> the border, around the content.
<code>border</code>	The line around the padding: <code>1px solid #333</code> .
<code>margin</code>	Space <i>outside</i> the border, between boxes.
<code>box-sizing</code>	<code>border-box</code> makes width include padding & border.

TIP

Shorthand runs clockwise from the top: `margin: 10px 20px 10px 20px` is top, right, bottom, left. Two values = `vertical horizontal`.

Display

Value	Behaviour
block	Takes full width, starts on a new line (<code>div</code> , <code>p</code>).
inline	Flows within text, ignores width/height (<code>span</code> , <code>a</code>).
inline-block	Flows inline but accepts width/height.
none	Removes the element from the page entirely.
flex	Turns the element into a flex container (see below).
grid	Turns the element into a grid container (see below).

Position

Value	Behaviour
static	The default — normal flow.
relative	Nudge from its normal spot with <code>top/left</code> ...
absolute	Placed relative to the nearest positioned ancestor.
fixed	Pinned to the viewport — stays on scroll.
sticky	Scrolls, then sticks when it reaches an edge.
z-index	Stacking order — higher sits on top.

Flexbox — one-dimensional layout

Set `display: flex` on a **container** to arrange its children in a row or column.

```
.container {
  display: flex;
  justify-content: space-between; /* along the row */
  align-items: center;           /* across the row */
  gap: 16px;
}
```

CSS

Property (on container)	Controls
flex-direction	<code>row</code> (default) or <code>column</code> .
justify-content	Alignment along the main axis (<code>center</code> , <code>space-between</code>).
align-items	Alignment across the main axis (<code>center</code> , <code>stretch</code>).

Property (on container)	Controls
<code>flex-wrap</code>	<code>wrap</code> lets items flow onto new lines.
<code>gap</code>	Space between items.

Grid — two-dimensional layout

Set `display: grid` to lay children out in rows *and* columns.

```
.container {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr 1fr; /* 3 equal cols */
  gap: 16px;
}
```

CSS

Property	Controls
<code>grid-template-columns</code>	Number & size of columns. <code>fr</code> = a share of free space.
<code>grid-template-rows</code>	Number & size of rows.
<code>gap</code>	Space between all rows & columns.
<code>repeat(3, 1fr)</code>	Shorthand for three equal columns.

Handy extras

Property	Effect
<code>border-radius</code>	Rounds corners: <code>8px</code> , or <code>50%</code> for a circle.
<code>box-shadow</code>	A drop shadow: <code>0 2px 6px rgba(0,0,0,.2)</code> .
<code>opacity</code>	Transparency from <code>0</code> (invisible) to <code>1</code> .
<code>cursor</code>	<code>pointer</code> shows the hand cursor on hover.
<code>transition</code>	Animates changes smoothly: <code>all 0.2s ease</code> .

Go deeper in Day 3

This sheet is the quick reference. Day 3 — Advanced CSS — walks through the box model, Flexbox and Grid with worked examples so these properties click into place.